

Richard Álvarez

rawalvarez731@gmail.com / GitHub / LinkedIn / Chicago, Illinois

About Me

Full-stack web developer and IT support technician with hands-on experience in hardware, software, and network troubleshooting. Began coding in childhood, led programming clubs in high school, and supported clients through my father's IT consultancy. Seeking entry-level technical roles where I can apply problem-solving and communication skills.

Education

Kenyon College

Gambier, Ohio

Bachelor of Arts in Film; GPA: 3.4/4.0

Aug 2020 – May 2024

Minor in History and Concentration in Integrated Program in Humane Studies

Authored two papers on machine learning applications in creative industries. Produced and edited over 15 experimental video projects, including music videos, audio-reactive visualizations, and short films.

Relevant coursework includes Senior Research Seminar, AI for the Humanities, Advanced Post-Production, Data Structures and Program Design, Digital Photography, Research Strategies in the Contemporary Age, and Software Development.

IT and Cloud Support Skills

Technical Support: Windows/macOS troubleshooting, software and hardware installation, remote support, user training, ticket management

Networking: VPN setup, basic network configuration, security monitoring, device provisioning

Cloud: Office 365, Google Workspace, basic Azure/Intune familiarity

IT Operations: Asset management, system imaging, hardware deployment, IT project support

Soft Skills: Customer service, documentation, troubleshooting, teamwork, problem-solving

Work Experience

Freelance Web Developer

Remote

Self-Employed

2020 – Present

Design, build, and maintain custom web applications for clients in creative and commercial industries. Translate business needs into responsive, high-performance websites. Provide technical documentation and training as needed.

- Built a full-stack e-commerce platform for a skate brand using Next.js, Tailwind CSS, and Node.js, with Stripe API integration and secure checkout.
- Developed a dynamic portfolio site for a cinematographer with a custom CMS and optimized video hosting via DigitalOcean.
- Created GRE vocabulary flashcard app using LangChain + OpenAI, with authentication and persistent user data.
- Delivered sites with 95%+ Lighthouse scores, focused on speed, accessibility, and mobile optimization.

IT Assistant

Gambier, Ohio

Kenyon College, Library and Information Services · Part-time

Sep 2023 – Feb 2024

Handled 8–15 support tickets per week across multiple departments. Imaged and deployed Windows PCs, reset user credentials, and configured classroom AV systems including projectors and microphones. Created and maintained an automated scheduling spreadsheet to map class times to maintenance windows, improving team coordination. Safely erased and backed up over 100 Mac laptops as part of the decommissioning process, and authored a step-by-step guide to standardize the workflow.

Competition Support Technician

Chicago, Illinois

BDPA High School Coding Competition · Volunteer

Apr 2024 – Present

Set up 18 laptops for a coding competition for nine teams, including OS flashing and hardware configuration. Managed troubleshooting requests during the live event and supported faculty and judges on technical setup. Assisted in inventory management and system checks pre/post competition.

Certificates

CompTIA ITF+ Sep 2024

CompTIA A+ In Progress